UX Design Document: SkillUP

Assignment: Group Design D
Team: Frame by Frame
Date: October 2026

1. About this document

This document shows who we design SkillUP for and what we will change for the final website. The changes come from the Design D evaluation in our UX report (Frame by Frame, 2026). None of them are built yet.

2. Design phases so far

SkillUP was built in phases. Phases A to C each used one principle from class.

Table 1: The design phases of SkillUP

Phase	What we built	Principle	Outcome
A	Landing page, log in and sign up popups, About page	Jakob's Law	Familiar layouts help people find their way.
B	Course catalogue as a list	Fitts's Law	Large click areas make the list easy to use.
C	Cart, checkout, lessons and progress	Peak-End Rule	Paying and finishing a course stand out.
D	Usability test and UEQ with five people	Evaluation	Easy to use but not exciting. A few moments break.
E	Final website	All of the above	Planned in this document.

3. Persona

Lindiwe is our main persona. Like the lecture advises, she is based on behaviour (University of Pretoria, 2026a). Her habits come from what our participants did. Her must nots come from problems we saw.



Lindiwe Nkosi

Junior analyst who prepares weekly reports

"I want to pull my own numbers instead of waiting for someone else."

Key goal: Produce her weekly report on her own without waiting for the data team.

Motivation: Wants to be trusted with more work and to grow in her role.

Habits	Must	Must not
• Searches first and moves to the filters when search fails. • Judges a course by its card before she opens it. • Expects every click to show a visible change. • Looks at the middle of the screen, not the corners.	• Show the level and price on every course card. • Confirm each action where she is already looking. • Give proof of completion for her manager.	• Ask for payment before she has signed in. • Leave her data on a shared computer after she logs out. • Promise anything the site does not deliver.

Figure 1: Persona for SkillUP. Photo by WOCinTech Chat, CC BY 2.0.

4. Task model

Lindiwe's main goal is to learn a skill she can use at work. Table 2 shows each step, what she needs and the problem we found. The decision types come from lecture (University of Pretoria, 2026a).

Table 2: Task model for learning a new skill

Stage	What she does	What she needs	Decision	Problem (# in Table 3)
1. Find	Searches or filters by Data and Beginner	Search that works with several words. A visible level	Direct connection	Search finds nothing (4). Level hard to spot (14)
2. Choose	Compares level, length and price. Reads the outline	Facts and outline near the top	Controlled, then complex evaluation	Page looks finished early (8)
3. Buy	Adds to cart, signs in and pays	Clear steps and a safe sign in	Direct connection	Pays without signing in (2). Unclear steps (11)
4. Learn	Marks lessons done and moves on	A visible change after each lesson	Direct connection	Mark done shows no change (1)
5. Finish	Finishes the course and judges it	A certificate and a review	Complex evaluation	No certificate or review (5)

Choosing is her hardest decision. For that reason, the course page must show the facts and outline near the top. How a course ends decides whether she comes back.

5. User journey

Figure 2 shows Lindiwe's journey in the new design. Each step shows the main change she will meet and how we want her to feel. The biggest change is at the end. A certificate turns finishing a course into the high point of the journey (Kahneman et al., 1993).

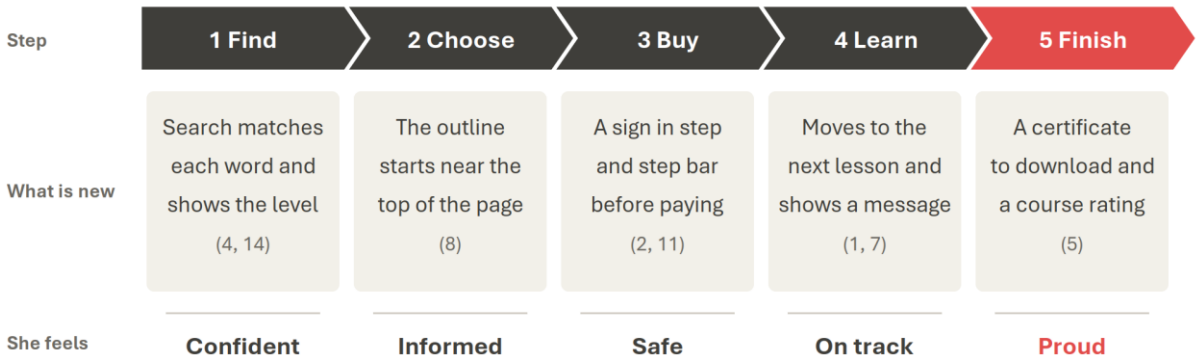


Figure 2: Lindiwe's journey in the new design. Numbers in brackets are changes in Table 3.

6. Planned changes

We tried every problem again on our site to find its cause before we chose a fix.

Table 3 links each problem to a fix and gives it a MoSCoW priority. Must fixes trust or a main task. Should improves the experience. Could can wait.

Table 3: Planned changes

#	Problem	Planned change	Why	Priority
1	Mark done seems to do nothing	Scroll to the next lesson and show a message there. Keep the side list in view.	Visibility of system status (Nielsen, 1994)	Must
2	Checkout works without logging in	Ask people to sign in before payment. Guests can still fill a cart. Show a padlock and safety note.	Builds trust where the secure item scored 0.40	Must
3	Data stays after logout	Save cart and progress per account. Clear them on logout and confirm it.	Protects shared computers	Must
4	Search seems broken	Make the search icon a real button. Match single words and suggest searches.	Jakob's Law (Yablonski, 2020)	Must
5	No certificate or review at the end	Add a certificate with a download button and a rating at the end of a course.	Peak-End Rule (Kahneman et al., 1993)	Must
6	Join SkillUP shows after log in	Show Continue learning to signed in people.	Consistency and standards (Nielsen, 1994)	Must
7	Messages go unnoticed	Show messages at the top centre for longer.	Von Restorff effect (University of Pretoria, 2026b)	Should

#	Problem	Planned change	Why	Priority
8	Course page looks finished	Shorten the top so the outline shows without scrolling.	Removes the false end of the page	Should
9	Filters push content down	Put all filters in one row of dropdowns and reduce spacing.	Hick's Law (Yablonski, 2020)	Should
10	Flat celebration with no close button	Add a close button. After paying show the course moving into My learning.	User control (Nielsen, 1994). Peak-End Rule	Should
11	Steps to enrol unclear	Add a step bar to cart and checkout and a browse link on My learning.	Shows people where they are	Should
12	Sign up messages out of view	Show messages at the top of the form and check fields while typing.	Error prevention (Nielsen, 1994)	Should
13	Public code shows the fake backend	Remove the browser test switch and backend notes from the code.	Advice from P5	Should
14	Course level hard to spot	Show the level as its own tag.	Recognition rather than recall (Nielsen, 1994)	Could
15	No way to load more courses	Add a Show more button after 12 courses.	Prepares for more courses	Could
16	Dark mode looks less polished than light mode	Give dark mode its own colours and clearer layers. Make form controls match and keep all text at 4.5 to 1.	Aesthetic-usability effect (University of Pretoria, 2026b). WCAG (W3C, 2023)	Should

Real payments and accounts are out of scope because they need a full backend.

Figure 3 shows the page behind change 1 which is our first must change. After Mark done and continue the page stays at the button. The title of the next lesson sits above the screen.

The only signs are the side list and a small message in the corner, where P4 said she never looks. Change 1 moves the page to the top of the next lesson and shows the message there.

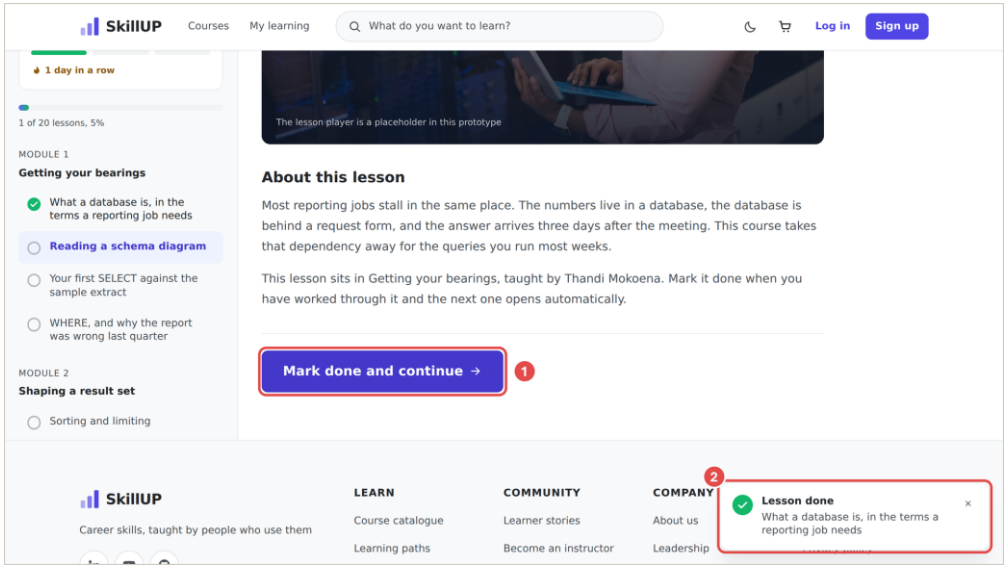


Figure 3: The lesson page right after Mark done and continue on a laptop screen. The page stays at the button (1) and the only message is in the corner (2).

Figure 4 shows the page behind change 2 which is our second must change. A visitor who has not signed in can still open checkout and type card details. Change 2 adds a sign in step before this form with a padlock and a short safety note. Guests can still fill a cart first.

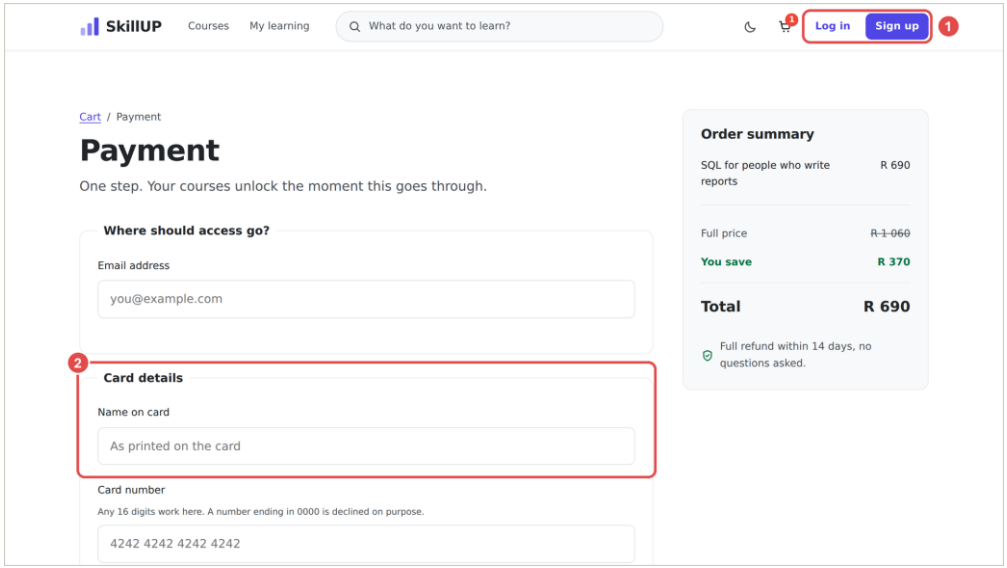


Figure 4: The checkout page for a visitor who is not signed in. The header still shows Log in and Sign up (1) but the card details are open (2).

7. Plan for the final website

Must changes come first, then should changes and a retest. Could changes follow if time allows. The retest should show that everyone sees the next lesson after Mark done and nobody can pay without signing in. We also aim for UEQ hedonic quality above 0.8 and a secure score above 1.0.

8. Conclusion

SkillUP already works for its main tasks and is easy to use. We will fix trust and feedback first and then make finishing a course worth remembering. The retest with the same tasks and the UEQ will show whether the changes worked.

References

Frame by Frame (2026) *UX report: evaluation of SkillUP*. IMY 320 Group Design D. University of Pretoria.

Kahneman, D., Fredrickson, B.L., Schreiber, C.A. and Redelmeier, D.A. (1993) 'When more pain is preferred to less: adding a better end', *Psychological Science*, 4(6), pp. 401-405.

Nielsen, J. (1994) *10 usability heuristics for user interface design*. Nielsen Norman Group. Available at: https://www.nngroup.com/articles/ten-usability-heuristics/ (Accessed: 11 October 2026).

University of Pretoria (2026a) *Theme 2-2: UX design document* [Lecture slides]. IMY 320 Multimedia Trends. University of Pretoria.

University of Pretoria (2026b) *Theme 4-5: Aesthetic-usability effect and Von Restorff effect* [Lecture slides]. IMY 320 Multimedia Trends. University of Pretoria.

W3C (2023) *Web Content Accessibility Guidelines (WCAG) 2.2*. Available at: https://www.w3.org/TR/WCAG22/ (Accessed: 11 October 2026).

Yablonski, J. (2020) *Laws of UX: using psychology to design better products and services*. Sebastopol, CA: O'Reilly Media.